

Chapter Two Fragrance Brief

6 October 2026 · Benny Aquilina, TEL Collection

Prepared for JAJI Parfumerie, Wednesday 7 October 2026, 12:30, Brisbane. The same brief goes to By Luis, Williamstown, the week of 12 October.

The house

TEL Collection is a lifestyle brand built around elevated essentials, founded in Surfers Paradise by Benny Aquilina, owner of Squires Ink and seventeen years under the needle. It is not an aftercare company and it is not a skincare company. Chapter One happened to be aftercare because that is where the founder has spent his working life and where the standard could be proven on his own skin first.

What Chapter One proved. The Ritual Duo (Restore Balm and Recovery Cream, 60 ml each, sealed as a set, A\$59.95) opened on 10 September 2026 as a numbered run of five hundred. Four weeks in: twelve reviews, all five stars, and sell-through running at the counter of a working studio with no advertising behind it. The product is made under ISO 22716, every batch is lab tested, and the full ingredient lists are published in order, exactly as they read on the jar.

The chapters model. TEL releases in chapters. Each chapter is one object, one numbered run, named only once it is earned. When the run is gone, the chapter closes. The list hears first and gets the doors 24 hours before anyone else. Chapter One is the proof chapter. Chapter Two is the brand chapter.

The standard. Two lines carry the house: *Earned. Not given.* and *Tested. Not claimed.* TEL does not make a claim it cannot evidence and does not publish a thing it has not documented. That applies to the fragrance as much as to the balm.

Chapter Two

Chapter Two is a wearable fine fragrance. One signature scent, released as a numbered run, sold online to the list. It is the first object TEL makes that has nothing to do with the chair.

What it is

- A fine fragrance that stands on its own, worn by people who may never buy the Ritual.
- The house signature: the one scent TEL is known for, not the first of a range.
- Unisex by default. The brand has never split its customer by gender and will not start here.
- Documented like everything else TEL makes: IFRA certificate, allergen declaration and SDS in hand before a bottle is sold, and the olfactive structure published.

What it is not

- Not a scent for a skincare product. The Ritual is going fragrance-free in its next run; the two chapters do not share a smell.
- Not a tattoo-themed novelty. No ink, no studio, no "for the tattooed" on the bottle.
- Not a flanker, a seasonal or a discovery line. One scent, done properly, before any second.
- Not a counter product. It is not designed to sit beside a till.

The wearer

The TEL customer pays for things made properly and can tell the difference. Mostly 25 to 45, Australian, found through Instagram and word of mouth, buying on a phone. Many are heavily tattooed, which is how they met the brand, but that is not what they are buying here. They are buying the standard.

They wear the scent the way they wear the work: daily, close, chosen once and kept. They are not fragrance collectors and they do not want a shelf of bottles. They want one that is theirs.

Picture him at 7pm on a Thursday: work done, showered, sitting down somewhere good with people he chose. He owns one watch, one wallet, one fragrance, each bought once after thinking about it, and none of them replaced on a whim. TEL's job is to be the one he does not replace.

Olfactive direction

This is a proposed direction drawn from the brand, for Benny to confirm, sharpen or replace before the meeting. The perfumers should treat the references as the real brief and the words as a starting point.

The feeling. Earned, not given. Quiet confidence, worn close. Dark without being heavy. Warm without being sweet. It should smell like something that has been kept well: leather that has aged, wood that has been oiled, skin at the end of a long day. Nothing in it should announce itself.

Proposed structure

STAGE	DIRECTION	KEEP AWAY FROM
Opening	Bright and clean. Bergamot or a cold citrus with a little pepper, confident for the first ten minutes, then gone.	Sugary citrus, aquatic or ozonic notes, anything that reads as sport
Heart	Aromatic and dry: a smoky note (birch, tea or incense), a dry iris or a quiet floral under it.	Rose or jasmine up front, gourmand notes, anything powdery
Base	Dry woods, an ambergris-style musk, a light aged leather. Long, skin-close, low sillage after the first hour.	Vanilla, oud as a headline, loud synthetic ambers

Performance. Eight hours on skin, close projection after the first hour. Built to be worn every day, not for an entrance.

References

Benny wears, and keeps coming back to, three houses: Creed, Louis Vuitton and Montblanc. Aventus is the one. The perfumers should read the pattern, not just the bottles.

The story in those three. None of them is a fragrance company first. Louis Vuitton made trunks. Montblanc made pens. Creed dressed courts before it bottled anything. Each is a house with a craft at its centre that later put its name on a scent, and the scent carried the standard of the house. That is TEL's exact position: a house built on one craft, now putting its name on a fragrance that has to carry the same standard. The wearer is not buying a perfume brand. He is buying the house.

What the pattern says about the scent. Ten bottles, and eight of them are bright, clean and aromatic. Two are dark. So the signature sits in the Aventus family, bright and recognisable on top, with the depth of the two dark ones held in the base rather than announced. Quieter, drier and longer than any of the ten, with the sweetness taken out.

The bottles. Benny will talk through what he would keep and what he would change in each at the table.

- **Creed Aventus.** The anchor. The reference for structure, performance and the way it is recognised across a room.
- **Creed Green Irish Tweed, Silver Mountain Water, Viking.** The house classics: two cold and green, one spiced wood.
- **Louis Vuitton Afternoon Swim, Pacific Chill, Orage, Sur la Route.** The fresh side of the house: citrus, air, salt.
- **Louis Vuitton Ombre Nomade.** The one dark exception: oud and rose. This is the depth the base should carry, not the opening.
- **Montblanc Explorer.** The Aventus-adjacent one: bergamot, vetiver, patchouli. Proof that the structure works at a quieter volume.
- **Montblanc Explorer Platinum, Legend Red, Signature.** The recent ones.

Avoid at all costs

- Anything that could be mistaken for a mass-market men's fragrance.
- Anything that smells medicinal or like the balm. The two chapters must not meet.
- Anything that needs a story to be understood.

Format, run and price

	PROPOSED	NOTE
Concentration	Eau de parfum, around 20%	Benny's working figure. To discuss at the table whether the formula wants 18 or 22.
Bottle	50 ml, with 100 ml discussed	5 L of oil at 20% makes about 500 bottles at 50 ml, or 250 at 100 ml. 50 ml keeps the run at five hundred and the price under A\$200.
Run	500, numbered	Same discipline as Chapter One. When they are gone, it closes.
Retail	A\$189 inc GST for 50 ml, proposed	Sits above Goldfield & Banks and below the European niche houses.
Discovery	2 ml vials, 300 to 500	Sent to the list before doors open. The sample is the launch.
Packaging	Heavy glass, black, gold-filled engraving to match the metal card. Rigid box.	TEL sources; perfumer advises on closure and compatibility.

Why 50 ml and not 100. It keeps five hundred numbered bottles in the run, holds the price where the TEL customer already buys, and leaves the 100 ml for a later edition if the first sells through. The oil cost per bottle is roughly A\$7 to 9 at 50 ml, so the price is set by the brand, not the juice.

Both the bottle size and the price are proposals, to be tested against the perfumers' view of the formula on the day.

The standard

TEL publishes. That is the one thing the perfumer needs to accept before the brief is worth discussing.

What TEL will publish with the fragrance

- The olfactive structure: top, heart and base, in the perfumer's words.
- The allergen declaration, as it appears on the box, in full.
- The concentration, the batch number and the run number on every bottle.
- The IFRA conformity statement, on request, to anyone who asks.

What TEL needs from the perfumer, in hand before the first bottle is sold

DOCUMENT	WHY
IFRA certificate of conformity, category 4 (fine fragrance)	The claim "tested, not claimed" has to be true for the scent as it was for the balm
Allergen declaration (the 26 EU allergens, and the extended list)	Goes on the box and on the website
Safety data sheet for the concentrate	Required by the compounder, the filler and the freight forwarder
Stability of the finished juice at the chosen concentration, with the chosen alcohol	TEL commissions stability on its own products; the fragrance is no exception
Shelf life of the bulk oil once opened	A 5 L minimum lasts a 500-bottle run; TEL needs to know how long the balance keeps

What TEL will not do

- Describe the scent with claims it cannot evidence. No "pheromone", no "clinically", no wellness language.
- Publish the formula or ask for it where the perfumer's model keeps it. Continuity is the question, not disclosure.

Timeline (target)

MILESTONE	WHEN
JAJI meeting, Brisbane	Wed 7 Oct 2026
By Luis meeting, Williamstown	14 to 16 Oct 2026
Perfumer chosen, Stage 1 signed	by Fri 30 Oct 2026
Development rounds (3 to 5)	Nov 2026 to end Jan 2027
Regulatory assessment (up to 6 weeks)	Feb to mid-Mar 2027
Bottle, closure and box ordered (8 to 10 week lead)	mid-Feb 2027
Bulk oil, compounding, maceration, filling	mid-Mar to end Apr 2027
Discovery vials to the list	early May 2027
Doors open, Chapter Two	Thu 3 Jun 2027, 7pm (target)

Commercial questions for the meeting

The fees are known. What is not settled is continuity, and that is the decision between the two houses.

What JAJI has put in writing (12 Sep)

ITEM	JAJI
Stage 1, design and development	A\$5,000 inc GST
Stage 2, regulatory and technical	A\$2,000 inc GST
Stage 3, bulk oil	A\$700 to 900+ a litre plus GST, 5 L minimum, repriced before each run
Formula	Stays with JAJI. Exclusive to TEL under the Master Fragrance Framework Agreement. Purchase option only if JAJI ceases its fragrance business.
Change of control	"Reasonable endeavours" that a successor honours the agreement

To settle on Wednesday

1. The purchase option. What triggers it, what it costs, and how long the process takes. TEL needs a number and a clock, not a process.
2. Prolonged inability to supply. How long is "prolonged", and what does TEL get at the end of it.
3. Change of control. Can "reasonable endeavours" become a binding assignment of the agreement to any successor.
4. Exclusivity scope. Does it cover the accord, or only the exact formula. Could a near-identical scent be made for another client.
5. Attribution. Can TEL say "composed by JAJI Parfumerie", and does JAJI want it said.
6. Rounds. How many development rounds Stage 1 covers, and what a further round costs.
7. Oil price. Can the first run's price be held for a second run placed within twelve months.
8. Shelf life of the bulk oil, and whether a 2 L or 3 L top-up is possible between runs.
9. Compounding and filling. Who JAJI works with in Australia, and whether they will introduce TEL.
10. Timeline. From a signed brief to an approved formula, in weeks, on their recent projects.

The comparison TEL is making

By Luis (Melbourne, meeting the week of 12 October) assigns the full quantitative formula to TEL on completion, compounder-ready, with no supply lock-in. Price is scoped at the meeting. The question for JAJI is what their framework offers that outright ownership does not. The honest answer may be the perfumers themselves. TEL wants to hear it.

What we want from this meeting

- A read on whether JAJI hears the brief as a fine fragrance or as a skincare extension. If it is the second, the meeting is short.
- Their reaction to the olfactive direction and the references, and what they would push back on.

- Answers to the ten questions above, or a date by which they will be in writing.
- Their view on 50 ml against 100 ml, and on 20% concentration for the direction described.
- A sense of how they work in the room. The scent is built over months of sitting together.

After the meeting

- ☐ Benny sends By Luis a date for 14, 15 or 16 October and this brief, with the JAJI answers held back.
- ☐ Both proposals side by side by Friday 23 October: fees, ownership, continuity, timeline.
- ☐ Perfumer chosen and Stage 1 signed by the end of October.
- ☐ Name and bottle direction briefed to the designer in November, so packaging lead times run alongside development.
- ☐ The list opened for Chapter Two the day Stage 1 is signed. The list is the launch.